Mazen Maalaoui

Tech Lead ● Full Stack Engineer - Laravel / PHP & Java / Spring Boot

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Technical Lead and Full Stack Engineer with 9+ years of experience building, modernizing, and scaling enterprise web platforms across the Laravel/PHP and Java/Spring Boot ecosystems. Currently lead the modernization of a mission-critical platform - consolidating applications, decoupling services, and shipping AI-powered features, including a proprietary LLM. Strong command of high-performance PHP (Laravel Octane, FrankenPHP), event-driven architecture, and cloud-native delivery on Docker, Kubernetes, and GCP, backed by a rigorous testing and static-analysis culture. Experienced people and technical leader who has grown from Backend Developer to Tech Lead through a company acquisition, mentoring engineers and aligning architecture with business goals.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: PHP, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL

Backend: Laravel, Lumen, Laravel Zero, Spring Boot, Spring Security, REST APIs, Microservices, API Gateway, Inertia.js, Laravel Octane, FrankenPHP, Laravel Reverb, Web Scraping & Crawling (custom Artisan commands), OOP, SOLID, Design Patterns

Frontend & Mobile: Vue.js, React, Inertia.js, Tailwind CSS, Bootstrap, jQuery, HTML5, Vite; React Native, Ionic, Framework7, Cordova

AI Engineering: LLM training & fine-tuning (Llama 3.1 8B), AI feature integration, NLP, AI-assisted development (Claude Code, GitHub Copilot)

Databases & Search: MariaDB, MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch

Messaging & Events: Apache Kafka, Queues, Events & Broadcasting (Laravel Reverb), WebSockets

DevOps & Infrastructure: Docker, Kubernetes, GCP, Jenkins, CI/CD, Maven, Gradle, Nginx, Apache

Quality & Testing: PHPUnit, Pest, JUnit, PHPStan, Rector, PHP CS Fixer, SonarQube, Sentry, strict typing, typed properties, PHPDoc annotations

Security: Secure coding practices, OWASP Top 10, web application vulnerability assessment, foundational penetration testing (information gathering, vulnerability exploitation)

Leadership & Practices: Technical Leadership, Team Leadership, Agile & Scrum, Code Review, Mentoring, System Design, Performance Optimization, Clean Code

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Bsamply - a Dedagroup company

Nov 2020 - Present | Tunisia

Acquired by Dedagroup Group in July 2022. Progressed from Backend Developer to Tech Lead over 5+ years; currently hold three concurrent roles within the Dedagroup holding.

Full Stack Developer - Java / Spring Boot / React — Jan 2026 - Present

- Develop full, end-to-end features across Java/Spring Boot backends and React frontends built on the company's internal component libraries.
- Design and secure REST APIs with fine-grained, role- and permission-based access control using Spring Security.
- Build event-driven services with Apache Kafka and persist data in PostgreSQL.
- Manage Maven and Gradle builds, author automated tests with JUnit, and maintain Jenkins CI/CD deployment pipelines.
- Accelerate delivery and code quality using Claude Code as an AI development assistant.

Engineering Program Coordinator ***(concurrent)*** — Jan 2025 - Present

- Act as a formal, on-demand engineering coordinator across the Dedagroup holding, engaged when team leads or product owners have specific needs regarding a developer.
- Coordinate and support a cross-stream group of four (three developers and a UX/UI designer) embedded in different teams.
- Run monthly 1:1s to track growth, well-being, and performance, surfacing and resolving blockers and organizational friction.

Tech Lead - Laravel / Vue.js ***(concurrent) ● Project: B/community*** — Jul 2023 - Present

- Lead a team of up to seven engineers rebuilding B/community as a more secure, higher-performance version of the original platform.
- Consolidated two applications into one and decoupled web API logic from mobile API logic for cleaner, independently evolvable services.

- Delivered AI-powered product features, including a proprietary LLM trained on Llama 3.1 8B, alongside enhanced search capabilities and a redesigned UX built with the product designer.
- Architected on Laravel 11→12 (PHP 8.3→8.4) with Vue.js and Inertia.js, MariaDB and MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch, and queues, events, and broadcasting via Laravel Reverb.
- Drove the platform's upgrade from Laravel 11 / PHP 8.3 to Laravel 12 / PHP 8.4, remediating known PHP 8.3 security vulnerabilities.
- Boosted performance with Laravel Octane and FrankenPHP, containerized with Docker, and deployed on Kubernetes over GCP.
- Cut worst-case API response time from 30+ seconds to under 500ms, and typical endpoint latency from ~300ms to 50-100ms, through query optimization, caching, and high-performance PHP.
- Enforced engineering quality through PHPStan, Rector, PHP CS Fixer, PHPUnit, Pest, SonarQube, and CI/CD; set technical strategy and mentored the team as primary technical decision-maker.

Backend Team Lead Aug 2022 - May 2023

- Led four backend developers delivering custom business-logic features on Laravel/PHP 9.
- Organized and dispatched work, owned code reviews and merge requests, and mentored junior developers.
- Worked across MariaDB and MongoDB, queues, model observers, and Elasticsearch, collaborating closely with design and frontend teams.
- Maintained CI/CD deployments across development, demo, and production environments.

Backend Developer • ***B2B Fashion E-commerce Platform*** Nov 2020 - Jul 2022

- Helped bootstrap a microservices architecture using Lumen behind a Laravel 8 API Gateway.
- Owned the Products domain and the admin back-office while contributing across every platform feature.
- Built dedicated per-event-group queues, a custom email-sender service, and a Node.js PDF-generation service.
- Developed a web-crawling/cards tool with Laravel Zero; worked with MariaDB, MongoDB, Redis caching, and Elasticsearch.

Shift Mar 2017 - Oct 2020 | Tunisia

Full Stack Developer

- Delivered a wide range of client projects: web platforms, mobile and hybrid apps, web-based and Facebook games, and Windows kiosk-mode (borne) applications.
- Built the FMI match-sheet platform (web and mobile) for the Tunisian Football Federation - officially approved by FIFA - covering league/season/club/player management, match calendars, player stats and transfers, referee workflows, licensing via third-party APIs, and a push/email/SMS notification center.
- Delivered a multilanguage e-commerce platform for CSM-GIAS with X3 ERP synchronization, an advanced discounting engine, back-office, web/mobile analytics, and a card/VIP-tier-aware search engine.
- Built a custom CRUD generator on Laravel 5.1 that accelerated delivery across numerous smaller projects.
- Created custom Facebook Live-themed apps that fetched live user comments to power real-time polls and statistics.
- Developed cross-platform mobile/hybrid apps with React Native, Ionic, Framework7, and Cordova; integrated a local SMS gateway and Firebase/FCM push notifications.
- Handled DevOps and system administration: manual VPS configuration, Nginx/Apache, cPanel, and SSH; wrote Windows batch scripts to lock down kiosk machines (disabling external USB ports).
- Core stack: Laravel, Vue.js, jQuery, Bootstrap, Chart.js, MySQL, and Firebase.

EDUCATION

Master's Degree, Web & Multimedia - ISIK 10/2015 - 06/2018 | Tunisia

Bachelor's Degree (License), Applied Multimedia and Web - ISIK 01/2012 - 06/2015 | Tunisia

LANGUAGES

Arabic - Native | English - B2

INTERESTS

3D Modelling and Printing, Gaming